Jon Toews

Creative Director | Creative Technologist

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SUMMARY

Creative director in advertising, design and digital, leading teams of up to 120 at Klick Health, Critical Mass, Public Inc. and Bensimon Byrne. I build brand, digital and experiential work for regulated and complex categories (healthcare and pharma, financial services, B2B technology). Work recognized at Cannes Lions, the Clios, New York Festivals and Communication Arts.

EXPERIENCE

Creative Director, Intercept

Toronto, Ontario | 2025–Present

- Lead creative for global enterprise technology brands at a Toronto B2B agency.
- Concepted interactive, mobile-first activations that bring Lenovo's workstation and Intel-powered AI PC story to FIFA watch-party events and Lenovo.com.
- Develop AI-forward and programmatic concepts, including interactive territories for the agency's own holiday campaign.

Sessional Instructor, Faculty of Design, OCAD University

Toronto, Ontario | 2018–2027

- Teach Advanced Copywriting (ADVR-3010) in the Advertising program.

Executive Creative Director, Klick Health / Katalyst

Toronto, Ontario | 2019–2023

- Led and mentored a 50-person creative team, including four creative directors, on a $60M business.
- Built Axsome Therapeutics' corporate brand and communications system, the Auvelity launch platform for major depressive disorder, and won five future-indication assignments.
- Led MDD disease-awareness work recognized by New York Festivals, Communication Arts and Creative Floor.
- Repositioned and redesigned Klick's own brand and Klick.com to attract talent; wrote, directed and scored the Klick holiday film (Clio, Creative Floor).

Executive Creative Director, Public Inc.

Toronto, Ontario | 2017–2019

- Led strategists, designers, writers and content creators on purpose-driven work for Converse, Scotiabank, Universal, Danone, the City of Toronto, Meals on Wheels, Girl Scouts of the USA and Fresh City Farms.
- Won and executed Converse's social-responsibility platform for its recycled shoe line.

Executive Creative Director / General Manager, Critical Mass

Toronto, Ontario | 2013–2016

- Ran the 120-person Toronto office, with oversight of creative, client service, project management and technology on $50M of brands.
- As global executive creative director on Citi, led Future of Banking discovery and prototypes on five- and ten-year horizons, piloted in markets worldwide, and reframed Citi's marketing platform as "Citi OS."

- Helped win NASA's ground-up web redesign with speculative concepts and working prototypes, then led delivery across technology, UX, content and design.
- Sweeper for UNMAS (Cannes Lions, New York Festivals, Communication Arts) and the Massey Lectures app for House of Anansi (Cannes Lion, Design).

Creative Director / Managing Director, Bensimon Byrne / Mighty
Toronto, Ontario | 2008–2012

- Led the agency's digital practice: 30 people across technology, creative, planning and client service. Member of the senior management team.
- Created Scotiabank's "Let the Saving Begin" platform under "You're Richer Than You Think."

SKILLS

Leadership: Creative team leadership and mentoring, Pitching and new business, Client partnership, Multi-discipline studio management

Craft: Integrated campaigns, Brand identity and design systems, Digital product and UX, Experiential and interactive, Film and animation direction, Copywriting, Music and sound

AI & technology: Generative AI for concepting and production (image, video, LLM), AI-agent prototyping, Creative workflow automation, Web prototyping (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Web Audio), Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud

Sectors: Healthcare and pharma, Financial services, B2B and enterprise technology, Public sector and non-profit, Consumer brands

AWARDS

Cannes Lions (incl. Design), Clio Awards, New York Festivals, Communication Arts, Creative Floor

CREATIVE PRACTICE

- jontoews.com/projects: experiments in emergence: simple rules and small systems that grow into instruments, worlds and language.
- Graphic design: typography.
- Published short-fiction writer; composer and music director.